Djokovic Loses and Misses the ATP Finals

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Novak Djokovic's tennis season is over. The 39-year-old star lost to Rinky Hijikata of Australia in the second round of the Paris Masters on Wednesday. The score was 2-6, 6-3, 6-3. Hijikata is **ranked** 83rd in the world and had to **qualify** to play. The loss means Djokovic will miss the ATP Finals in Turin. He likely needed to reach the **semi-finals** in Paris to **qualify**. Djokovic started well, but Hijikata played better late in the match. Djokovic looked tired and made many errors. After the match, Djokovic said his plan is "just **rest**." "I'm looking forward to it," he added. He also praised Hijikata: "He played really amazing tennis." Djokovic has won a men's **record** 24 **Grand Slam** titles. This is only the second time in 20 years that he has failed to **qualify** for the season-ending event when fit. He reached the Australian Open final and the Wimbledon **semi-finals** this year. Now only Taylor Fritz and Tommy Paul still have a chance to take the last two spots in Turin.

Word Treasure

qualify -- To qualify means to earn a place in a contest.
semi-finals -- The semi-finals are the round before the final.
Grand Slam -- A Grand Slam is one of the four biggest tennis tournaments.
ranked -- Ranked means placed in order by how good a player is.
record -- A record is the best result ever.
rest -- Rest means taking a break to get better.

Background you need

In tennis, players must win match after match to reach the final.

The ATP Finals is a big tournament for the best players of the year.

Break it down

WHO: Novak Djokovic and Rinky Hijikata
WHAT: Djokovic loses in Paris and misses the ATP Finals
WHERE: The Paris Masters
WHY: Hijikata played better late in the match

Why it matters

Even the best player in the world can lose, which is why watching sports is so exciting.

Test what you remember

1. Who beat Novak Djokovic?

(A) Taylor Fritz
(B) Daniil Medvedev
(C) Alexander Zverev
(D) Rinky Hijikata of Australia

2. What was the score?

(A) 6-3, 6-3, 6-3
(B) 6-2, 6-3, 6-3
(C) 2-6, 3-6, 3-6
(D) 2-6, 6-3, 6-3

3. What will Djokovic do for the next few weeks?

(A) Play another tournament
(B) Retire
(C) Train harder
(D) Just rest

4. How many Grand Slam titles has Djokovic won?

(A) 24
(B) 18
(C) 22
(D) 20

5. How many times has Djokovic missed the season-ending event when fit in 20 years?

(A) Five times
(B) Ten times
(C) Every year
(D) Only twice

6. Who can still take the last two spots in Turin?

(A) Taylor Fritz and Tommy Paul
(B) Tiafoe and Jodar
(C) Halys and Etcheverry
(D) Zverev and Medvedev

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: D 4: A 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Novak Djokovic: says he will just rest and that Hijikata played really amazing tennis

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):